

7.1 Short and long term strategies

There are a variety of management strategies or responses governments, organisations and communities can implement to overcome, reduce or prevent water scarcity. Some are short term, and aim to fix a water scarcity issue quickly. Some are long term strategies that aim to reduce and prevent water scarcity over a long period of time. Both types of strategies have advantages and disadvantages.

In the table below, identify if each strategy is long or short term, and justify your choice.

Strategy	Long or short term?	Justify why
Building a dam: Storing large amounts of water to provide a reliable supply over many years.		
Desalination plant: Turning seawater into drinking water to create a long: term water source.		
Emergency tanker water supply: Bringing extra water from outside areas when local sources are too low.		
Improving irrigation efficiency: Updating irrigation systems and pipelines to reduce water loss over time and using smarter irrigation methods (like drip systems) to save water in farming.		
Installing water: saving devices: Using taps, showerheads, or toilets that use less water to reduce consumption quickly.		
Public awareness campaigns: Teaching people how to save water during shortages.		
Rainwater harvesting: Collecting rainwater from roofs or surfaces for ongoing use.		
Recycling wastewater: Treating used water so it can be safely reused for irrigation, industry, or even drinking.		
Water restrictions and rationing: Limiting how much water households, farms, and businesses can use to conserve water immediately.		

Answer these questions in your book:

1. Which strategy do you think would be most effective short term, and why?
2. Which strategy do you think would be most effective long term, and why?
3. Rank the strategies from most to least effective, in your opinion. Justify your rank.